Own Your Tee Sheet

A step-by-step guide to leaving trade times and owning your tee time inventory

From **Fairway Found**, SEO and local search for public golf courses. This guide is general information, not legal advice. Review your contracts with your attorney.

Step 1. Audit your current agreements

List every marketplace and tee sheet contract. Record trade rounds given, days and times, renewal dates, notice periods, and exclusivity or early-exit terms. Have your attorney review before you change anything.

Step 2. Measure what trade times really cost

Multiply annual trade rounds by your average green + cart fee, then add per-round or per-booking fees. This is your budget for doing it yourself.

Step 3. Set up or optimize your own booking engine

Online booking should be fast, mobile-first, take payment or a card on file, and be two taps or fewer from every page of your site.

Step 4. Turn on booking from Google

Claim and complete your Google Business Profile, add a direct booking link, and ask your tee sheet provider whether it supports Reserve with Google.

Step 5. Build SEO and local content

Create pages for how golfers search: tee times near me, twilight, junior and senior rates, leagues, events, and nearby areas. Add golf course schema and earn reviews.

Step 6. Grow your email/SMS list and loyalty

Collect consent at booking and check-in. Send off-peak offers, weather openings, and loyalty perks.

Step 7. Wind down trade inventory in phases

Within your contract terms, reduce trade rounds step by step, starting with times your own channels already fill. Monitor utilization and adjust.

Step 8. Track and report every month

Measure direct online rounds, revenue, utilization, and cost per booking against your baseline. Advance phases only when the numbers support it.

Trade time cost formula

Annual rounds traded = trade rounds per day × days open per year
Value given away = rounds traded × average green + cart fee
Fees paid = (rounds traded × per-round fee) + (online bookings × per-booking fee)
Total annual cost = value given away + fees paid

Example input (illustrative only)	Value
Trade rounds per day	4
Days open per year	320
Average green + cart fee	$55
Annual rounds traded	1,280
Estimated value given away	$70,400

Assumes every traded round could have been sold at your average rate, so this is an upper-bound estimate. Example values are not a client result.

Direct-booking readiness checklist

[ ] Online booking engine on your own tee sheet

[ ] Booking works on a phone in under 60 seconds

[ ] Takes payment or card on file

[ ] Book button on every website page

[ ] Google Business Profile claimed and verified

[ ] Google booking link goes to your own booking flow

[ ] Rates published on your site

[ ] Email/SMS opt-in collected at booking

[ ] Analytics tracks completed bookings

[ ] You know your marketplace notice period and renewal date

Next step

Run the free SEO scorecard on our website, or ask for a manual review by a strategist.